Expression Builder

TEACHER KEY

5th Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Type or tap to build numerical expressions with parentheses, brackets and braces, then watch them evaluated one step at a time. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. Evaluate 4 + 3 × 2. What is done first?
3 × 2 first; the answer is 10.

2. Evaluate (4 + 3) × 2.
14

3. Evaluate 2 × [5 + (6 − 2)]. List the steps.
6 − 2 = 4; 5 + 4 = 9; 2 × 9 = 18

4. Evaluate {20 − [3 × (4 − 1)]} ÷ 11.
1

5. Put parentheses in 3 + 5 × 2 to make it equal 16.
(3 + 5) × 2

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Explore more

6. Write an expression for: add 8 and 7, then multiply by 2.

(8 + 7) × 2 = 30

7. How does 3 × (125 + 48) compare with 125 + 48?

3 times as large

Reflect

8. Reflect: Why do we need grouping symbols?

They show which part to do first, so everyone gets the same answer.

Teacher notes

Accept equivalent forms (for example 1/2 = 2/4 = 0.5) and any correct example where several answers are possible. Have students explain using the tool's picture.